Book 5: The Sword, the Scholar, the Supernatural & the Scapegoat

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Mathias The Matheist

The Scapegoat

On the Day of Atonement the high priest cast lots over two goats, one for the LORD and one for Azazel. On the second he laid both hands, confessed all the iniquities of the people, and sent it into the wilderness: “the goat shall bear upon him all their iniquities unto a land not inhabited” (Leviticus 16:22). William Tyndale, translating in 1530, called it the scapegoat. The faiths that took Israel’s book turned the ritual on Israel. A people who can be blamed for the death of God can be blamed for anything; once that door shuts, the rest come easy. Islam carried the book’s God by the sword, behind a man called perfect; Christianity sold him as a man-god, wrapped in the supernatural. The scholars who kept reading the book for themselves, wrestling with it instead of kneeling, would sign neither rewrite. So they became the scapegoat, sent into the wilderness again and again, and they keep coming home.

Some of what follows was argued in Book 1. It comes back here briefly, so this book stands on its own, and then goes deeper.

The Sword, Perfect for All Time?

A morally problematic mortal prophet called perfect for all time is a virgin mother. What mortal is perfect? Perfection is a divine attribute. Assigning it to a man brings the human idol back into the religion that forbids it. How is that not the shirk Islam claims to reject? The real shirk is any supernatural. La ilaha illa ar-riyadiyyat: no god but math. No man is perfect.

Muhammad married Aisha when she was 6 and consummated the marriage when she was 9 and he was 53, per Sahih Bukhari and Sahih Muslim, the two most authoritative Sunni hadith collections.

Islamic jurisprudence developed the concept of mufa’khathat, thigh intercourse permitted with a wife below the age of penetration. Compare the ages. The federal indictment in Manhattan charged Jeffrey Epstein with trafficking girls as young as fourteen. At the trial of his partner Ghislaine Maxwell, the witness called Jane testified she was fourteen when the assaults began. The Justice Department identified over 1,200 victims and

their relatives. Muhammad’s Aisha was between five and eight years younger than Epstein’s youngest charged victims, counting from consummation at nine or marriage at six against the documented fourteen. One is called a monster. The other is called the perfect moral exemplar for all time.

Muhammad’s forces conquered the Jews of Khaybar. In the biographical tradition, Zaynab lost her father, uncle and husband. She offered Muhammad a poisoned roast sheep. He ate it. The hadith’s warning comes after the taste; his companion Bishr died. It does not take prophecy to suspect danger in food offered by someone whose family your forces have just killed. The cruelty and the lack of foresight speak for themselves.

Quran 69:44-46 says that if the messenger fabricated revelation, God would sever his aorta. Sahih al-Bukhari 4428 has Muhammad say on his deathbed, “I feel as if my aorta is being cut from that poison.” The threatened punishment for the false messenger becomes the dying image of the supposedly perfect one. These are the tradition’s own words.

The book gets the same claim as the man: perfect, uncreated, identical to the letter. Jay Smith, a Christian critic of Islam, claims 93,000 differences across thirty printed Quranic readings. The

total depends on how variants are counted, but at minimum, twenty recognized Arabic transmissions produce visible differences in wording on the printed page; this is standard Islamic scholarship, not a polemical claim.

Then the cut-and-paste. Jesus makes a bird from clay in Quran 3:49, as in the earlier Infancy Gospel of Thomas. Quran 18 reworks the Christian story of the Seven Sleepers. The ingredients were already in circulation. The Quran selects and revises. Calling it uncreated does not erase its sources.

Then the cost of leaving. Sahih al-Bukhari 6922 prescribes death for changing religion. Abu Dawud 4462 prescribes death for the sexual act associated with the people of Lot. Quran 24:4 demands four witnesses for an accusation of illicit sex, with punishment for an unsupported accusation. These are texts and rules to confront, not wave away by calling the exemplar perfect.

In Judaism, you can stop believing and remain Jewish. Identity does not disappear with belief. That is different from demanding faith under threat of death.

The people in the Hebrew Bible acknowledge their shortcomings and failures. That’s how we fix things: by first acknowledging a problem. A man who can never be wrong cannot show you how

to correct yourself.

The world's false idols pressure truth into diamonds. Israel is the suffering servant, the "boy named Sue," made tough by the hardships of life. Muhammad and Jesus weaken their followers when made into "Mary Sues": faultless, miracle-working heroes. Worship of perfection teaches you to need the perfect one. Wrestling with failure teaches you to grow.

Islam forbids bowing to any creature, then asks its faithful to treat one man as perfect for all time. Its own mystics saw the tension. In the Quran, God tells the angels to bow down before Adam, and Iblis, the devil, refuses: "I am better than him. You created me from fire and him from clay" (Quran 7:11-12). Hallaj, the Persian Sufi mystic executed in Baghdad in 922, made Iblis the purest monotheist in heaven, who would bow to God alone. Ahmad Ghazali, a Sufi preacher and the younger brother of the theologian al-Ghazali, is reported to have preached that whoever does not learn tawhid, God's oneness, from Satan is an unbeliever. Matheism reads the devil another way: his devotion is to non-monism, a God kept apart from his creation. Either way, the bow he refused is the bow now asked for Muhammad, raised beyond what is natural, as Christians raised Jesus.

Metaphysical children seek a sky daddy in heaven, not valuing themselves, not knowing the meaning of life is to live, needing someone else to give them the purpose. Seeking an answer instead of being it. Seeking arrival instead of being what has arrived.

The Scholar

Against the perfect man stands a people raised to argue, even with God: Abraham haggled with him over Sodom, from fifty righteous men down to ten (Genesis 18:23-32). Judaism is not a skin color. It is a family that coheres around an idea, around the Torah, around the commitment to spreading its light, but it does not say what God is, let alone prove it. Its abstract nature does not contradict Matheism's proof the way a single man as the son of God or pagan beings taken as supernatural would. Matheism completes what it left open.

In choosing, you are chosen to spread the light of the One Math God, as its agents are called Elohim all over the bible. You do not need the bloodline. Once you see that all is math, you are called.

Judaism is culture, the software a people runs.

The land, the law, and the people are one. It is not only a religion. The abstract God keeps out the man-god, the human god, the endless supernatural inventions. There is no end to supernatural nonsense, but there is only one truth. The value is in keeping out the supernatural while preserving the mythological metaphor, the mystery that keeps the question open. A law above kings cannot be reduced to a face on a throne.

Debate, literacy, abstraction, the demand to wrestle with reason for truth rather than submit to authority. What you do after you stop believing reveals what your tradition built into you. The cultural engine runs after the religion is dropped. That is the good news: a culture can be chosen, and this one, the one that wrestles, is available to everyone.

Much of Jewish scientific achievement came from secular Jews. The belief can go; the learning, the argument, and the belonging remain.

Greeks and Romans called Jews atheists for refusing to worship the gods. The charge was half right. The Roman historian Tacitus gave the reason: Jews “conceive of one god only, and that with the mind alone,” and “set up no statues in their cities.” Pagans accepted a personalized God in the body of Jesus. Most Jews did

not. Blame Jews for the supernatural? They kept less of it than anyone.

Judaism already understood: there is no outside. No supernatural realm above creation. The lack of an afterlife focus is the strongest argument that Judaism does not require supernaturalism at its core. Job proved it: doing good tends to be rewarded, but not always. Most of the Hebrew Bible sends the dead to Sheol, a shadowy pit; the only clear promise of resurrection comes late, in Daniel, around 165 BCE, after two centuries under Persia, and historians still argue over how much it took from Zoroastrianism. Eden is not above. It is here. The mythological wrapping is the benign fungus, keeping out the one that commandeers the ant.

Christians that both love and hate Jews say: if the Jews are not supernaturally powered, then they are geniuses these Christians cannot imagine. Their philosophy, that the land, the law, and the people are one, revived King Arthur's Camelot England in Excalibur and helped found America with meritocracy, capitalism, personal responsibility, and laws above kings.

What other people have done what they have done? Who else survived millennia of religious and racial persecution and exile,

from their home in Israel, yet survived all other empires, still singing, hallelujah, both the faithful and the secular, in their small numbers? Who else projected their will to life and the truth across the world and across millennia of time?

Keeping an identity under persecution takes stubbornness, solidarity, and the courage to face injustice. It takes parents teaching children, people helping one another, and learning that can travel when possessions cannot. These are strengths a community carries forward. Good people, and many would-be Einsteins, were lost. Zechariah saw two thirds struck down. Two thirds of the brothers, two thirds of my parents' children, in many ways my betters. I am the one that remained, left to share the one truth.

Laws excluded Jews from offices, professions and education; quotas limited their admission. The history spans over 1,500 years, from restrictions in the late Roman Empire to modern university quotas and Nazi dismissals. Where rulers let them in, as the Abbasid caliphs of Baghdad did, their work went out under the rulers' banner.

The "Islamic" Golden Age wasn't Islamic. It was built largely by Persian, Jewish, and Christian scholars working under an empire

that had not yet closed the door on philosophy, in lands taken from Persia and Christendom. Nobody calls Newton’s laws Christian physics, or the Renaissance the Christian Golden Age. Hunayn ibn Ishaq, who put Galen’s medicine into Arabic, was a Nestorian Christian; Thabit ibn Qurra, who translated Euclid and Archimedes, was a Sabian star worshipper from Harran; al-Khwarizmi, whose book on al-jabr gave us the word algebra, was a Persian from Khwarazm whose family may have been Zoroastrian. Ibn Khaldun, the fourteenth-century Muslim historian, wrote that “only the Persians engaged in the task of preserving knowledge and writing systematic scholarly works.” It ended when it did: al-Ghazali’s 11th-century work declared philosophy incompatible with faith and effectively closed the inquiry. The revival was built on translation of Greek texts by non-Arab scholars. The end was an act of theology. Call it golden. Ask who mined the gold, and who locked the mine.

America

In “Judeo-Christian,” the hyphen hides which half does the work.

The Alhambra Decree gave Spain’s Jews until July 31, 1492: convert or leave. Those who remained or returned faced death and confiscation without further trial. Those leaving could sell

their property, but could not take gold, silver or coin. Departures continued through August 2. Columbus sailed on August 3, one day later. The New World opened as the old one shut its door on the Jews.

The Jewish connection ran through the financing and the crews. Luis de Santángel, a converso royal finance officer, helped finance the first voyage. Luis de Torres, a Jewish convert, sailed as interpreter because he knew Hebrew and Arabic and somebody assumed the Indies would answer in one of them. Archival research names other men of Jewish ancestry on the first and fourth voyages. Columbus's own possible crypto-Jewish identity remains disputed.

Columbus left thirty-nine men at La Navidad in 1492. The converso interpreter Luis de Torres was among them; none survived. Jewish participation in the Americas began with the first voyage, in lives as well as money.

For the national seal, Franklin proposed Moses parting the sea; Jefferson proposed the Israelites in the wilderness. The Liberty Bell carries Leviticus: "Proclaim liberty throughout all the land unto all the inhabitants thereof." They reached for a people leaving bondage, not a ruler demanding worship.

Jefferson cut out the supernaturals from his Bible with a razor. In 1823 he wrote to John Adams, the second president, that “the day will come when the mystical generation of Jesus, by the supreme being as his father in the womb of a virgin will be classed with the fable of the generation of Minerva in the brain of Jupiter.” Jefferson knew Newton’s Principia. He wrote “Nature’s God” into the Declaration of Independence.

The founders drew on Athens and Jerusalem alike; their heirs tend to remember one. Marco Rubio, the Secretary of State, at the Acropolis in 2026, said the Greeks gave the West the conviction that the cosmos has a rational order, governed by laws the mind can understand. The order and the laws are one thing: math.

In the same speech, Rubio traced America to Athens, Rome, Christendom, medieval Europe and English liberty. He left out Jerusalem. Asmongold, a popular streamer, reacting live, called the West a triforce of Greek philosophy, Roman law and Christian morality. The morality is Jewish: love your neighbor as yourself is Leviticus 19:18. In August, Greece signed a three billion euro deal for its new air defense, the Achilles Shield, built from Israeli systems.

The vitalist right worships ancient Athens. Modern Athens chose Israel to guard its skies. Greece kept its land and its language through every empire that ruled it. Israel kept its language and its law through every exile, and came home. Two of the oldest peoples of the West are allies again, and both are rising.

Adams wrote in 1809: “I will insist that the Hebrews have done more to civilize Men than any other Nation.” In 1819: “I really wish the Jews again in Judea an independent nation.”

Washington wrote to the Jews of Newport that America “gives to bigotry no sanction, to persecution no assistance.” Religious freedom was an inherent right, not a favor granted by another faith. He reached for Micah’s image: each person safe beneath their own vine and fig tree, with none to make them afraid.

Haym Salomon helped finance the Revolution and died with large claims still unpaid. Jewish contributions to the republic were ideas, money and lives.

What set America’s revolution apart from France’s was covenant versus contract. A contract is two parties extracting mutual benefit and dissolving when the benefit stops. A covenant binds both sides to something above both. France wrote a contract and ate itself inside a decade. America wrote a covenant.

America also inherited from Greece, Rome, English law and the Enlightenment. But the biblical language of its republic was Jewish before it was Christian.

The Ten Commandments reach from action into desire: do not covet what belongs to your neighbor. Honor your mother and father, your creators. Learn from your competitors instead of envying them. Learn to be, to become able. In the Matheist reading, the rejection of idols becomes the rejection of supernatural authority over reason.

The excessive craze of Christian mind control via anti-sex sin shame selling cynically leverages the lowest emotion in the psychiatrist David Hawkins's map of consciousness, selling salvation from the damnation of shame. It is yet another example of why we live in a more energetic, open-minded, creative, rational, free-trade capitalist Judaic America, and less in a purely puritanical or stifled anti-wealth "camel through a needle's eye" Christian country.

Revelation's elect are virgins "not defiled with women" (14:4); in 1139 the Catholic church declared its priests' marriages void. Judaism made marriage holy and its pleasure a blessing: the first of the Torah's commandments is be fruitful and multiply, a

husband owes his wife her “duty of marriage” (Exodus 21:10), and in the Talmud a man without a wife lives “without joy, without blessing, without goodness” (Yevamot 62b). Rabbi Akiva, the second-century sage, called the Song of Songs, a book of love poems, the holy of holies. Early America sided with the Hebrews: Puritan Boston’s First Church expelled James Mattock, among other offenses, for denying his wife “conjugal fellowship” for two years, and America’s Protestant pastors marry, as rabbis do. In a 2019 survey, half of American Christians told the Pew Research Center that casual sex between consenting adults is at least sometimes acceptable. Half the flock doesn’t buy the shame.

The Christian Bible contains an anti-wealth strain: the rich man told to sell his possessions. Yet in Matthew’s parable of the talents, five become ten, two become four, and both servants are rewarded. The servant who buries his talent loses it to the one who made ten. Here, he who creates wealth is rewarded with more to put to work. Repeating what produces nothing will not produce wealth.

The emerging good emerges from the ethics of individuals: decentralized, trading what they want less for what they want more in free market enterprise capitalism. The decentralized calculator in the sky is here, in the exchanges between us.

Protect life, liberty and property; let people create and trade.

Money spent is not wealth made. Two projects can spend the same billion. One builds a power plant; the other leaves nothing that produces. Both bid for workers and materials now. Only one adds power later. Count what was built, when it begins to work, and what the spending displaced.

Add up the seal, the Liberty Bell, the covenant and the talents: Israel is not a rival to the American idea. It is the template: rules above rulers, a duty of literacy, argument as the method, and merit over birth.

Christianity says kneel. Islam means submission. The name Israel means: wrestle. Stand upright, see eye to eye with truth. Jacob lied to his blind father to steal his brother Esau's blessing. It haunted him. Years later he wrestled an angel through the night and told the truth: I am Jacob. For honesty he earned the blessing, the name, and the covenant land named for it, before the colonizing Romans and Islamic Arabs renamed it. Lie to get what you want, and it haunts you. Tell the truth, and you become Israel, who wrestles to know truth.

The lie has its own feeling too, and it is the easy fall off the one path. There is one truth and a countless, infinite supply of lies,

and holding to the one takes the same work as the workout, the diet, the habit you build against the pull. The wind is always blowing toward the lie, because the lie bribes and the truth costs.

Written without vowels, Zion is tziyun, a signpost (Jeremiah 31:21): the marker the nations point at, to bless or to curse.

The Supernatural

Christianity's supernatural was assembled from Greek parts: a word, logos, read as a person, and a genre, the passion of a god who dies and rises. Read the word as logic and the genre as a pattern, and the supernatural falls away.

The Logos

"In the beginning was the thing", all things. "In the beginning was the Logos", or logic. Translators still fight over how the verse ends, whether the Word was God, divine, or a god, as the Jehovah's Witnesses translate it, since theos, God, there has no article. Word for word the Greek reads "God was the Logos," and the fight skips the noun. Logos means logic, thing and word, and then the verse makes sense. In Greek it also means reckoning and proportion, and it is Euclid's word for ratio, as if the word grew on its own to say all is logos. Heraclitus, a Greek

philosopher of about 500 BCE, heard it: “Listening not to me but to the logos, it is wise to agree that all things are one.” Matheism says it outright: math is God, and all is one. John’s opening is the most interesting part of the entire gospel, the whole truth and story: a meta storytelling about what the story is. Read plainly, in the beginning was the logos, logic, and God is logic and the word. The logic and the word were with God, and the metaphorical mythicist word became flesh. Logic is math, and math’s logic is Aristotle’s unmoved mover.

Philo, a Jewish philosopher of Alexandria writing half a century before John, had already explained the missing article. With it, ho theos, scripture means the totality of God; without it, “what he here calls God is his most ancient word” (On Dreams 1.230), the word he called God’s “firstborn son” (1.215). Men not yet fit to be called sons of God, he wrote, may still “be called the children of his eternal image, of his most sacred word” (On the Confusion of Tongues 147). Scholars count Philo among the Middle Platonists, who made Plato’s Forms the thoughts of God, and his Forms are no world apart: the world of Ideas “is nothing else but the reason of God,” his logos, “already occupied in the creation of the world” (On the Creation 24), and the world of the senses “was made on the model of it” (36), as a city is built from the plan in its

architect’s mind. Aristotle’s complaint that Plato’s Forms cause nothing misses him. What he held apart was God, with the logos standing “in the midst between these two extremities,” neither uncreated like God nor created like us (Who Is the Heir 205-206). Philo’s split made room for more than the logos: for Christianity’s one incarnate son. The word is also the mythology, or the metaphor, of creating that uncreated son that we are: eternal even in our birth and death, and in eternal recurrence and resurrections. Matheism leaves nothing beyond the logos. Its trinity is the logos; all its uncreated sons and siblings in its image, logos too; and the Holy Ghost, the field: what it feels like to be logos, the one self that feels “I am.”

The classicist Victor Davis Hanson, defining the West, lands on the word: we still worship the logos. He means reason, logic, the order of things. Perhaps he knows that the logos is the antithesis of the supernatural, but he may be stretching the case that the West worships the logos. The Christian West worships what it called the logos, yet wrapped in a supernatural ignoble lie.

The Passion

The Passion was a genre before it was a gospel. Four centuries before Jesus, the Greek historian Herodotus saw Egyptians at

Sais enact by night “the story of the god’s sufferings, a rite which the Egyptians call the Mysteries” (2.171). The god was Osiris, too holy for Herodotus to mention. Richard Carrier, a historian of early Christianity and a mythicist, who puts the odds that Jesus existed at one in three at best, lays out the pattern in a lecture on the mystery cults: in the Mediterranean under the Greeks and Romans, savior gods suffered, won victory over death, and shared it with those initiated into their cults, while China, India and Persia in those centuries grew no such cults. When one region grows the same religion in a dozen local costumes and its neighbors grow none, the parallels mark a trend.

The first god known to die and rise was a goddess. On Sumerian clay tablets from about 1700 BCE, Inanna, queen of heaven, goes down to the land of the dead. At each of its seven gates she gives up a piece of her regalia, her crown, her jewels, at last her robe, until she stands naked before her sister Ereshkigal, queen of the underworld, who fixes on her the eye of death. Her corpse hangs on a hook. After three days and nights her servant goes for help, and Enki, the god of wisdom, sends two creatures who sprinkle the corpse with the food of life and the water of life. Inanna rises. She sends her husband Dumuzi down in her place, and he dies and rises with the seasons. As Tammuz he reached

Jerusalem itself: Ezekiel sees women at the temple “weeping for Tammuz” (8:14).

Carrier lists others he can document before Christianity. Osiris, killed and cut apart by his brother Set, is put back together by his sister and wife Isis and rules the dead. Lucian, a satirist born in Syria, saw Adonis mourned each year until his worshippers “allege that he is alive again” (On the Syrian Goddess 6). Herodotus tells of Zalmoxis of Thrace, who hid three years in an underground chamber while his people mourned him as dead, and appeared again in the fourth. In the Roman historian Livy and the Greek biographer Plutarch, Romulus vanishes in a storm and returns from heaven to declare that Rome will be the capital of the world, and Rome worships him as the god Quirinus. Baal dies and returns in the poems of Ugarit. Dionysus, the wine god Bacchus, is torn apart and born again. Mithras, the Persian-born god of Rome’s soldiers, suffers a passion without dying and wins power over death through it. Carrier, no friend of the church, still throws out the internet’s favorite parallel: there was no mystery cult of Horus.

Carrier argues each cult was one Greek frame in local dress: Isis and Osiris for Egypt, Mithras for Persia, Attis and Cybele for Phrygia, Demeter at Eleusis for the Greeks themselves. You

were initiated into secrets, the mysteries, by ritual and sworn teaching. You were washed in a baptism, and you ate a sacred meal that reenacted the god's story. You gained brothers and sisters of any race or class, a family you joined by choice instead of birth. The old farm religions had saved the harvest of a whole community; the mysteries turned the yearly rising of the crops into the rising of the individual after death. Carrier sums up the age in four trends: syncretism, henotheism, individualism and cosmopolitanism.

Before the Greeks came the Persians. In Carrier's account, Judaism took from Zoroastrianism the war of a good God against an evil one, light against darkness, Satan and his fallen angels; hell for the wicked and heaven for the good; a river of fire that burns up the world, hell included, before God makes it new; and the resurrection of the righteous to live in it. In Job, the satan is still an officer of God's court, an accuser who comes with the sons of God to present himself before the LORD.

Elaine Pagels, the Princeton historian of early Christianity, reads what came next as social history: the war in heaven maps a war among people. In the Dead Sea Scrolls, from a sect that broke with the Temple priests and withdrew to the desert, Belial leads the sons of darkness: the Kittim, most likely Rome, and the Jews

the sect said broke the covenant. The Gospels inherit the war. In John, Jesus tells Jews who argue with him, “Ye are of your father the devil” (8:44), and Satan enters Judas. The devil is the rival, projected into heaven.

Carrier calls ancient Judaism henotheist, one God above lesser gods, because angels and demons were called by the same word as gods; what Judaism added, he says, was monolatry, the worship of one. Different Jews believed different things, but the Torah as it stands is strictly monotheist: “See now that I, even I, am he, and there is no god with me” (Deuteronomy 32:39), and the Shema, said morning and evening, declares the LORD one. Elohim, a plural for gods, may speak of an earlier time, yet from the first line of Genesis it takes a singular verb, and Jews still use it today for strictly one God. A shared word makes no second god: the Torah calls judges elohim (Exodus 22:8), and God tells Moses, “I have made thee a god to Pharaoh” (Exodus 7:1). By the Dead Sea Scrolls, the oldest copied in the third century BCE, the teaching is fixed: the Great Isaiah Scroll reads “I am the LORD, and there is none else” (45:5), and the earliest tefillin yet found, from the caves of Qumran, carry the Shema. Carrier reads the first Christians’ Jesus as one of the lesser divine beings, in effect an archangel; the church later made him God, and the

Torah had already ruled that out: “God is not a man” (Numbers 23:19).

Christianity, in Carrier’s reading, is the Jewish version of the mystery cult: the Greek frame built from Jewish parts. The savior son of God came from messianic hope, and his death from blood atonement. Each Yom Kippur, the blood of a bull and a goat atoned for Israel, and it had to be offered again the next year. The letter to the Hebrews gives the fix: “it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins” (10:4), so Christ “by his own blood ... entered in once into the holy place, having obtained eternal redemption for us” (9:12). One death, good forever, and no temple needed. On Moriah, a ram took Isaac’s place; Hebrews trades back, a son for the animal. Passover, the escape from the angel of death, shaped the meal, and John the Baptist’s washings supplied the water.

The Christians found their savior in scripture by a method the Dead Sea Scrolls share: pesher, interpretation, which reads verses written for one moment as a code for the end of days. They stitched passages into one man. In the Wisdom of Solomon, a Greek-Jewish book that Paul echoes, the righteous man “calleth himself the child of the Lord”; the wicked say, “Let us condemn him with a shameful death,” and at the judgment he is

“numbered among the children of God” (2:13, 2:20, 5:5). Daniel’s “Messiah be cut off” (9:26) most likely mourned the high priest Onias III, murdered in 171 BCE. In Zechariah, the high priest Joshua, in Greek Iesous, Jesus, is crowned and called the Branch, and God promises to “remove the iniquity of that land in one day” (3:8-9, 6:11-12). Philo, writing before any gospel, read the same verse, where the Greek calls the Branch “the East”, as the Logos, God’s “firstborn” and “eldest son” (On the Confusion of Tongues 62-63), and Carrier takes the Branch as a heavenly Jesus already in Jewish thought.

Greek scripture had its turn too. Dennis MacDonald, a New Testament scholar, reads parts of Mark and Acts as mimesis, the classroom art of rewriting Homer. In Mark, Jesus and his followers sail to a foreign shore and meet a wild man living among the tombs, whom no chain can hold, as Odysseus and his crew sail to the land of the Cyclops, a lawless giant living in a cave. Odysseus tells the giant he is called Nobody; Jesus asks the demon who it is, and it answers, “My name is Legion: for we are many” (5:9). Circe turned Odysseus’s men into swine; Jesus sends the demons into a herd of two thousand, and it drowns in the sea. Robyn Faith Walsh, a historian of early Christian literature, reads Mark’s secrecy the same way. Mark’s Jesus

keeps ordering silence about who he is, a theme the German scholar William Wrede called the messianic secret in 1901. In the Odyssey, the Phaeacians feast a stranger and wonder if he is a god come down from heaven, until he chooses to tell them he is Odysseus; home again, disguised as a beggar, he is first known by his old dog. The hero decides when he is revealed.

Josephus, the Jewish historian of the war with Rome, gives a model closer to home. In 62, four years before the war, a peasant called Jesus son of Ananias began crying woe against Jerusalem and the Temple at the Feast of Tabernacles. Leading citizens had him beaten and brought him to the Roman governor, Albinus, who had him flayed to the bone; he answered nothing, and was let go as a madman (Jewish War 6.300-309). Some scholars think Mark modeled his trial of Jesus on this one.

A Roman novel has the guarded cross and the missing body. In the Satyricon, credited to Petronius, the emperor Nero's arbiter of elegance, though the classicist Ulrike Roth and Walsh place its author in the second-century circle of Pliny the Younger, the Roman senator and letter writer, a soldier guards the crosses of crucified robbers beside a tomb where a widow mourns her husband. He goes in to comfort her, and they lie together for three days behind the tomb's shut doors, while the family of one

robber takes his body down. To save the soldier, the widow has her husband's corpse hung on the empty cross, and the next day the people wonder how the dead man got up there (111-112). Classicists count the story among the Milesian tales, bawdy stories older than both Petronius and the Gospels. Matthew posts soldiers at Jesus's tomb and has the priests pay them to say his disciples "came by night, and stole him away while we slept" (28:13). The same novel has a cock crow at Trimalchio's dinner, taken as a sign that a fire will break out or a neighbor will die (74), as a cock crows at Peter's denial, and the poet Eumolpus leaving his fortune to heirs on one condition: that they cut up his body and eat it in front of the people (141).

The errand at the tomb makes no more sense. Rabbi Tovia Singer, who has answered Christian missionaries for over thirty years, points out there'd be no reason to roll back the stone and put spices on the body, as an incense against the smell, because that's something you do before you bury it. In Mark the women bring spices at dawn after the Sabbath, to anoint him; in John, Nicodemus had already wound the body in linen with about a hundred pounds of myrrh and aloes, "as the manner of the Jews is to bury" (19:39-40).

Paul, writing some twenty years after the crucifixion, has no empty tomb at all. He isn't into bodies. His list of sightings uses one Greek word, ophthe, "was seen," for Cephas, the twelve, "above five hundred brethren at once," James, all the apostles, and "last of all ... me also" (1 Corinthians 15:5-8): his own vision counts the same as theirs. The five hundred appear in no other source; their sighting is hearsay, and even if true, they saw it spiritually, not physically: Paul says the dead are raised "a spiritual body" (15:44). The empty tomb first appears in Mark, some forty years after the crucifixion. Why didn't Paul mention it? The Greeks called a hero's rise to the gods apotheosis, and its sign was often a missing body, as with Romulus.

Where Christian rites part from Jewish washing, they match the mysteries. Paul's baptism is a death and rebirth: "we are buried with him by baptism into death" (Romans 6:4). In The Golden Ass, by the Roman novelist Apuleius, initiation into the cult of Isis is "a voluntary death," and the initiate comes out reborn. Paul mentions believers "baptized for the dead" (1 Corinthians 15:29), a rite Carrier traces to the mysteries; Plato mocked the priests of Orpheus who sold purifications for the living and the dead (Republic 364e), and the Mormons revived Paul's version. Paul calls his meal "the Lord's supper" and warns, "ye cannot be

partakers of the Lord’s table, and of the table of devils” (1 Corinthians 10:21). The rival tables left their invitations: a second-century papyrus from Egypt requests a guest’s company “at dinner at the table of the lord Sarapis.”

Paul speaks the cults’ language. He calls himself and his fellows “stewards of the mysteries of God” (1 Corinthians 4:1). He speaks wisdom “among them that are perfect” (2:6), teleioi, the cults’ word for the fully initiated, and feeds the rest milk: “as unto babes in Christ. I have fed you with milk, and not with meat” (3:1-2). Mark has Jesus say it outright: “Unto you it is given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God: but unto them that are without, all these things are done in parables” (4:11). Outsiders got the story; insiders got its meaning. By Mark’s own words, those who take the story literally are the ones outside.

Paul’s innovation sold it: gentiles could join without circumcision, circumcised in the heart (Romans 2:29). The God-fearers, gentiles who loved the synagogue and balked at the knife, poured in, and the original Torah-keeping sect shrank until it vanished; Carrier suspects Islam retooled a remnant of it, with halal as an heir of kosher. Women had room at first. Paul greets Junia, “of note among the apostles” (Romans 16:7). Around 112, Pliny the Younger, Rome’s governor in Bithynia, tortured two

slave women “styled deaconesses” for the truth about the Christians. “I suffer not a woman to teach” comes from 1 Timothy, a letter most scholars hold was written by someone posing as Paul, and Tertullian, a church father of the late second century, raged at heretic women bold enough “to teach” and even “to baptize.” In Carrier’s view, the church that won the emperor was the most patriarchal of them all. The first to rise had been a goddess.

Christianity’s growth needed no miracle. Rodney Stark, a sociologist of religion, estimated about 43 percent a decade, the rate of the Mormon church since its founding. Messiahs who promised to beat Rome by the sword died by Roman swords and crosses; a messiah whose victory was spiritual could not be refuted. Failure can even feed a faith: in When Prophecy Fails (1956), the psychologist Leon Festinger and his colleagues watched a doomsday group preach harder after its predicted flood did not come. The mysteries spread through the cities, where uprooted people wanted a salvation of their own, and the countryside held out longest; pagan comes from the Latin for a villager.

Carrier notes that each of the dying and rising gods was given a life on earth, walking among people, though none of them

existed, and he asks whether Jesus is the one exception. Since nothing supernatural foreshadowed him, the match is evidence, not silence: his story was built from theirs, against a historical Jesus and for mythicism. The matheist asks why the same story keeps coming back. A pattern that recurs across peoples is a structure, and structures are math. Inanna left something at every gate until she stood naked before death, and then she rose. The matheist's passion is his own life, and yours: the losses destiny will not undo, carried in gratitude for its blessings, and at every gate one more supernatural claim given up, until only the naked truth remains. What rises is the truth, and it was there all along.

The Scapegoated Tribe, Prophecies of People

Prophecies of people are accomplished by people. Israel is real. People returned, built, defended, argued, and built again. No supernatural rescue did their work for them. Every fulfilled Jewish prophecy is an unfulfilled Christian one.

Like the Foundation series psychohistory predictions of Isaac Asimov, the big predictions of the Hebrew Bible landed. If you make it part of the holiday order, the Passover seder, to pray to return and celebrate "next year in Jerusalem," eventually acts cause the world to align with your words and mind.

In Revelation 12, a woman crowned with twelve stars, the twelve tribes, is pregnant with the messiah. The woman is both Israel and Mary. The Son is Yeshua, salvation. The Crusaders marched to the Holy Land. The Grail knights searched for a cup. Eight centuries later, Theodor Herzl, a secular Jew who did not need the supernatural to act for what the Jewish people have prayed, for 1,800 years, set in motion the return of the exiles to the same land with the same law, the same language, the same God.

The oldest hatred now hides inside its own accusation. Supersessionist theology needs the Jews to have been cast off. A thriving Jewish state, in the Jews' own ancient homeland, contradicts the story of their permanent rejection. The intolerable thing is not only the land; it is that this people did not stay disproved.

Christianity and Islam together hold roughly 4.5 billion adherents. Both built their theology on the claim that they supersede Judaism: Christianity as the new covenant, Islam as the final revelation. Both needed the prior covenant to have been revoked.

Heirs who each claim the whole estate fight each other too. Wars over religion fill the record: two centuries of crusades from 1096; the French Wars of Religion, Catholics against Protestants from

1562 to 1598, with the St. Bartholomew's Day massacre of 1572; then the Thirty Years' War, from 1618 to 1648, which killed between 4.5 and 8 million people, a fifth or more of the German lands. Sunni and Shia have fought over the succession to Muhammad since Karbala in 680.

This is why there's a persistent Holy War. It requires a Holy Peace. The Hebrew prophecy is that when all know the One God of Truth, whom Jacob wrestled to level with and earn his name Israel, the One named "what will be will be," there will be world peace.

Its temple is to be built block by block by acts of loving kindness. Unite with honey on apples, not vinegar. When today's distortions, delegitimizations, demonizations, double standards, and deflections are seen eye to eye in the mirror of projection, the path will be paved towards this self-fulfilling prophecy, like M.C. Escher's "two hands drawing" themselves. If so, let it be.

What blocks that road was written in the first century. Christian anti-Judaism has roots in the founding texts. Judaism was the theological rival Christianity had to displace: it supplied the scriptures while refusing the new claim about their meaning. Rome supplied the empire in which the new faith had to spread.

Roman authority executed Jesus, yet Matthew gives Pilate a basin in which to wash his hands while the crowd accepts the blood upon itself and its children. The Roman governor declares himself innocent; a Jewish crowd is made to speak the line later used against generations of Jews. A Roman atrocity became a Jewish confession, authored by anonymous men courting the empire that committed it.

The curse that launched two millennia of persecution, “his blood be upon us and our children,” appears in Matthew alone, decades after the event. No other Gospel records it. Even within their own story, the Sadducee priesthood handed Jesus to Pilate and vanished with the Temple. Modern Judaism descends from the Pharisees, who in the Gospels defended him.

From the first gospel to John, the attack against the Jews grows progressively worse, for political reasons. Jews are constantly portrayed badly: Paul says they “killed the Lord Jesus” and “please not God, and are contrary to all men” (1 Thessalonians 2:15); Matthew’s Jesus calls the Pharisees a “generation of vipers” (23:33); in John, Jesus tells Jews, “Ye are of your father the devil” (8:44); Revelation calls a synagogue “the synagogue of Satan” (2:9). After the Roman war destroyed the temple, the new faith could not help but turn on Israel, the mother and father of

Christian faith. Rome itself was attacked only in code: in Revelation, Rome is the beast the dragon empowers, and 666 is Nero’s name in Hebrew gematria, where every letter is also a number. “My name is Legion,” says the demon. Who has legions? Rome. The Tenth Legion, which took Jerusalem in 70 and garrisoned its ruins, bore a boar as its emblem; in Mark, Legion goes into a herd of swine and drowns in the sea.

Once a theology calls the rival’s suffering deserved, persecution can present itself as confirmation of the theology.

The blood libel adds an inversion. Jewish law forbids consuming blood and condemns sacrificing children. Christian salvation centers on the Father’s sacrifice of his Son, Yeshua, whose name Matthew connects with saving his people. John speaks of eating his flesh and drinking his blood. Later accusers charged Jews with killing Christian children for ritual blood. The charge is older than the church’s power: pagan Rome accused the first Christians of eating babies and of incest at their night meetings, and once Christians ruled they turned it on the Jews. Bart Ehrman, the New Testament scholar, notes it is the charge every side throws at its enemy. The sacrificial son, saving blood and flesh belong to Christian sacred imagery; the accusation places murderous versions of them on the people whose law rejects

them. That is the projection I mean. The oldest inversion is older still. The first decree against the Hebrews was Pharaoh's order to kill their newborn sons (Exodus 1:16, 1:22). Matthew's Herod, Rome's king of the Jews, plays Pharaoh and kills the boys of Bethlehem (2:16), a massacre that Josephus, the Jewish historian who records Herod's murders down to his own wife and sons, does not mention. The charge that Jews kill children turns the first crime against them around.

Why did Jews reject the constructed Jesus as a messiah? He did not fulfill any of the prophecies. He did bring knowledge of the God of Israel, but in a dialectic mirror image, a projection and inversion. A false dichotomy.

The Torah's messiah isn't a miracle worker. He will teach, judge, and unite the nations by the unifying truth of the only possible one god.

Jews don't exist to reject Jesus. They don't "reject him" any more than they reject Vishnu. They reject being killed over it. Haven't you done enough? Jesus, please save us from your followers.

It is Christianity that says one Jew is the only god, man. The tradition that says Jews are rejected worships a Jew as God. The projection is the theology.

James Carroll, a former Catholic priest, finds a bigger bomb in the Gospels than the Christ-killer charge: the notion that Jesus wasn't Jewish. Every story needs a conflict, and the Gospels set Jesus against his own people, so each of his virtues is drawn against a Jewish vice: he is gracious and they are law-bound, he loves and they legislate. The Good Samaritan could as well be called the parable of the bad Jews: a priest and a Levite pass the beaten man by, and the outsider saves him. The love itself was Jewish: the Torah commands Israel to love the stranger "as thyself" (Leviticus 19:34). Once Gentiles ran the movement, by about 150, they read the story as if Jesus were no Jew. Asked what religion Jesus was, Carroll says, he would have answered as a Georgetown freshman that he was an Irish Catholic. Paul stayed a Jew too: his last free days end in the Temple, where he had gone to purify himself (Acts 21), and his welcome to the nations was Isaiah's end of days, when all nations would worship Israel's God.

Christianity and Islam each declared the parent rejected and replaced, took its God and its scripture, then accused the parent of the theft.

This is the move under all of it: identity crisis cured by identity theft. The people at the origin, who only kept saying the same

plain thing, that there is one God and one truth above kings, became the reproach the whole structure was built to silence. The hatred is not an accident of history. It is load-bearing, the price a false system pays to live beside the truth it took. That is why it repeats across centuries with the same pattern, and why standing for the Jews means standing for the truth itself.

The church cast its own savior as the scapegoat. The Epistle of Barnabas, an early Christian letter, has the goat spat on, pierced, crowned with scarlet wool and driven into the wilderness, and says, “Mark how the type of Jesus now comes out” (7). On the Christian god’s suicide, the sacrifice of an innocent man who is also his son: none should be sacrificed for the guilt of others, and vicarious atonement cannot cancel an ancestral sin debt. The Hebrew Bible already rejected it: God stops Abraham from sacrificing his son, and Ezekiel says the son shall not bear the guilt of the father.

Anselm of Canterbury gave the answer that stuck, in Why God Became Man (1098): God as a feudal lord whose wounded honor only a God-man’s violent death could satisfy. Carroll calls it a violent theology that underwrote violent politics. Three years earlier Pope Urban II had promised crusaders that the march to Jerusalem would count for all their penance; for centuries the

church had set penance even for killing in a just war, and now the war was the penance. A generation later Peter Abelard answered that God had not turned away from his creation: the fall only made people imagine he had, and Jesus came to change the human mind. Had Abelard carried the day, Carroll says, the West might have been spared its culture of holy violence.

Ehrman finds the same irony at the root. Jesus taught forgiveness, the father of the prodigal son running to embrace him with no payment asked (Luke 15), and his followers, needing a reason for his death, made it the atonement he had taught against. Paul, who barely speaks of repentance, taught atonement. Ehrman's picture: a daughter says she is sorry, and her father forgives her, then kills her kitten to make things even.

The lesser the Christology, the greater the truth. Zero supernatural for maximal truth. Truth is one divided by Christology.

The church fathers hated Jews because Jews could read the original Hebrew and expose the theology. Their own Zechariah 8:23 has ten gentiles grabbing the garment of a Jew at the end of days, saying, "We will go with you: for we have heard that God is with you." If the church replaced Israel, why are Christians

coming to Jews?

The fathers knew. Origen compiled six parallel versions of the Hebrew Bible and found the Greek Septuagint diverged from the original; rather than correct the Greek, he accused Jews of corrupting their own scriptures. Jerome learned Hebrew from Jewish teachers and translated from it, yet kept the church's readings where they mattered: Isaiah's young woman stayed a virgin. The hatred was not ignorance. It was the response of theologians who built everything on another people's book and needed those people silenced before they could tell the world what it actually says.

The test does not require outside critique. It requires reading the sources. Paul quotes as scripture "Eye hath not seen, nor ear heard" (1 Corinthians 2:9), a line no scripture contains in those words. The most dangerous thing you can do to any scripture is read it.

If you are selecting which lines to enforce, the selection is being made by reason, and reason is the thing you already had. In the beginning was the logos, and logos is logic. You do not need the book to get to the logic. You need the logic to read the book. Alan Watts told a Jehovah's Witness that a God who loved the human

race would not hand it an infallible textbook: a book that tells you what to do leaves your own judgment idle.

The Orthodox Church, three hundred million strong, locked this hatred into an unfalsifiable loop and never had its Vatican II. Its members read the Hebrew Bible only through these same church fathers: Chrysostom, Augustine, Basil, Athanasius. These are not merely cited as authorities; they are prayed to as saints, their words woven into liturgy. Augustine's City of God teaches that Jews survive in a degraded state as a warning of what happens to those who reject Jesus. The only permitted interpreters are the ones who declared God finished with the Jews, and no independent reading is allowed to test them.

Original sin is the first woke doctrine: collective guilt for an ancestor's act, absolved only by the institution that invented the debt.

Collective guilt has a modern form: the meme counting every country that ever expelled the Jews, offered as proof they earned it. The list of 109 countries tracks Christendom, not a controlled experiment. The expulsions map onto the spread of supersessionist theology, the same theology that needed the covenant revoked. Compiled on antisemitic forums, repeated as

though repetition were evidence. Count the unique decisions. Most were made by the same institution under the same doctrine across a thousand years. That is one data point with many echoes, not 109 independent experiments.

Jews were blamed for both capitalism and socialism, opposite accusations that cancel each other and reveal the source is not the behavior but the blamer. The Nazis hated Jews as a race; today's haters call them racists. In Hindu India and Confucian China, Jews lived for centuries without persecution from their hosts. The persecution tracks theology, not behavior.

There has always been a reliable audience for 109 to turn 110. The Jews have been a great, easy, time-tested target minority to gang up on whenever a scapegoat is needed. René Girard, the French thinker, explained why one is needed: we want what others want, so desire breeds rivalry and a cycle of revenge, and a community ends the feud by uniting against one victim, on a lie. The lie that the Jews killed Jesus still serves, though the Catholic Church disowned it in 1965. If anything, the Romans killed him, as they crucified thousands of Jews between rebellions, then washed their hands and changed their own story. Antisemitism, RFK Jr said, is "a spiritual and moral malady that sickens societies and kills people with lethalities comparable to history's

most deadly plagues.” Ben Shapiro, the conservative commentator, draws the line: racism hates a group, while antisemitism is a conspiracy theory that a group secretly runs the world, a fever that spikes when a society is already sick. Easy ended in 1948, three years after the Jews left the Holocaust camps as little more than skeletons.

Jordan Peterson, the Canadian psychologist who fights the woke, fell into the same pit from the other side: pressed by the neuroscientist Sam Harris for two hours, he redefined truth as whatever helps you survive, which is usefulness, not truth. He will not stand on the one floor that ends the argument. Reality is one structure, math, true whether or not power, survival, or fashion approves.

The Oldest Inversion

The modern charges against Israel run the oldest play. Occupation, colonialism, apartheid, genocide: each takes what was done to the Jews and pins it on them. Test each against the record, starting with the land.

The Land

There was never a sovereign state of Palestine. Not under the Ottomans, who ruled for 400 years. Not under the British Mandate. Not under Jordanian and Egyptian control of the West Bank and Gaza from 1948 to 1967. No Palestinian state has ever met the Montevideo Convention’s criteria for statehood: a permanent population, a defined territory, a government, and the capacity to enter relations with other states. Israel is called an occupier of a country that never existed.

In 1921, Britain separated Transjordan from the Palestine Mandate, handing roughly 78 percent of the mandated territory to the Hashemites. The Jewish national home was to be built in the remaining 22 percent. The 1947 partition proposed dividing that remainder, and more than half of the Jewish allotment was the Negev desert.

The Palestine Liberation Organization was founded in 1964, three years before Israel held the West Bank or Gaza. What was being liberated? The answer is Israel itself. Yasser Arafat, the PLO’s longtime leader, was born in Cairo. The national identity was constructed, in part with Soviet assistance, as a political instrument. The KGB’s involvement in constructing Palestinian nationalism as a Cold War weapon is documented by Ion Mihai Pacepa, the highest-ranking Soviet-bloc defector.

Al-Masri means the Egyptian. Al-Mugrabi means the Moroccan. Al-Djazairi means the Algerian. Al-Yamani means the Yemeni. Al-Afghani means the Afghan. Al-Hindi means the Indian. Al-Turki means the Turk. The surnames are a census. They record where the families came from, and it was not Palestine.

Mark Twain passed through in 1867 and described it in The Innocents Abroad: “There is not a solitary village throughout its whole extent, not for thirty miles in either direction.” “One may ride ten miles, hereabouts, and not see ten human beings.” “A desolation is here that not even imagination can grace with the pomp of life and action.” A land nearly empty, waiting.

The Jewish Virtual Library reports that Arab immigration from neighboring states constituted 37 percent of total immigration to pre-state Israel. Arab population grew 120 percent between 1922 and 1947, but the growth was wildly uneven: 290 percent in Haifa, 131 percent in Jerusalem, 158 percent in Jaffa, the Jewish-built cities, against 42 percent in Nablus and 37 percent in Bethlehem, the Arab ones. The Peel Commission found that the shortage of land was “due less to the amount of land acquired by Jews than to the increase in the Arab population.” Jewish development drew people in; it did not push them off.

The famous Shamouti orange emerged from an Arab grove and Jewish growers helped expand the citrus economy. The honest account can recognize an existing society and the scale of what Jewish immigration added. Making the whole country an empty desert would be wrong. Making it a fully settled Arab homeland with no room for Jews would be equally wrong.

In the Middle East Forum's 2003 study, Fred Gottheil analyzed the 1922 and 1931 British censuses and found 64,790 unaccounted-for Arabs in Jewish-designated sub-districts alone: 11.8 percent of the 1931 Arab population in those areas, representing 36.8 percent of the growth. The borders were porous and the count was low.

Jewish kingdoms existed across the ancient Middle East: Adiabene in Iraq, Khaybar in Arabia, Himyar in Yemen, La Kahina's kingdom in North Africa. Jews are indigenous not only to Judea but to the region. Jews from Khaybar settled in Hebron to be near the patriarchs' tombs. Under Saladin, they were forcibly converted to Islam. Their houses still show marks where mezuzahs hung. Arabs call them to this day El Yahud: the Jews.

A 2013 genome study found no evidence of a Khazar origin for Ashkenazi Jews; they share the greatest genetic ancestry with

other Jewish populations and groups from Europe and the Middle East.

Israel stands on the six grounds Book 1 set out: first, continuous, purchased, recognized, compromising, defended. Jewish presence held even through exile: Safed, Hebron, Tiberias, Jerusalem, never empty of Jews. Each ground alone is stronger than what founded India and Pakistan, whose 1947 partition killed up to two million and displaced fifteen million, yet no one questions their right to exist. That’s not the question. Anti-Zionists want Israel destroyed. Israel does exist.

Quran 5:21: “Enter the Holy Land which God has destined for you.” Quran 17:104: “We said to the Children of Israel, ‘Dwell in the land,’ and when the promise of the hereafter comes, We shall bring you as a crowd gathered out of various nations.” Allah is a Zionist. That was the bumper sticker. If the Quran is the word of God, the land belongs to the Children of Israel by divine command.

The analogy the anti-colonial left should understand best is the one it refuses to see. Jews are the Native Americans in this debate. They built kingdoms in Judea and Samaria, were conquered by Rome, scattered across two thousand years of

persecution, and returned to a land where their temples, scrolls, and burial sites still lay under the soil. The colonizers were the Romans, the Crusaders, the Ottomans, the British, and the Arab conquests of the 7th century. If indigenous return is justice everywhere else on Earth, it is justice here.

The bipartisan moral clarity is there for anyone willing to look. The patriot American right sees a democratic ally that fights its own wars, shares intelligence, and builds technology America deploys. The principled left should see a decolonization success: an indigenous people reclaiming ancestral land against empire. Both views arrive at the same conclusion. The only way to oppose Israel from either direction is to abandon your own stated principles.

The Offers and the Wars

A state was offered in 1937 by the Peel Commission. Refused. In 1947 by the UN partition plan. Refused, and five armies invaded. In 2000, at Camp David and after, Israel’s prime minister Ehud Barak offered Arafat roughly 95 percent of the West Bank, all of Gaza, and a capital in East Jerusalem. Arafat refused and launched the Second Intifada. In 2008 Prime Minister Ehud Olmert offered the Palestinian president, Mahmoud Abbas, a

similar deal with land swaps. Abbas walked away. Four offers. Four refusals. At some point the pattern is the policy.

Khaled al-Azam, Syria’s prime minister, wrote in his memoirs: “Since 1948, we have been demanding the return of the refugees to their homes. But we ourselves are the ones who encouraged them to leave.” The newspaper Filastin, published in Jordan, reported on February 19, 1949: “The Arab states which had encouraged the Palestine Arabs to leave their homes temporarily in order to be out of the way of the Arab invasion armies, have failed to keep their promise to help these refugees.” A British police report from Haifa, April 26, 1948, recorded Arab leaders urging evacuation while Jewish authorities asked Arabs to stay.

The violence predates the state. In 1941, seven years before Israel’s founding, the Farhud swept Baghdad. Over two days, mobs killed nearly two hundred Jews, wounded a thousand, and destroyed nine hundred homes. The Grand Mufti of Jerusalem, Amin al-Husseini, had arrived in Iraq two years earlier and spread Nazi propaganda there. A hundred and fifty thousand Jews had lived in Iraq for twenty-six centuries, since Babylon. Within a generation, nearly all were gone.

Between 1948 and the early 1970s, roughly 850,000 Mizrahi and Sephardi Jews were terrorized and expelled from Arab and Muslim countries: Iraq, Egypt, Yemen, Libya, Syria, Morocco, Tunisia, Algeria, Iran. They fled for their lives, often without their belongings. Their property was confiscated. No right of return was offered. No UN agency was created for them. No international campaign demands their homes back. They rebuilt. About half of Israeli Jews descend from these families. They are not white. They are not white-passing. The apartheid accusation is aimed at a country whose majority is Middle Eastern and North African.

The Arab refugees got an agency of their own. Every other refugee on earth falls to UNHCR, the UN refugee agency, which works to settle refugees until they stop being refugees. UNRWA, the UN agency for Palestinian refugees, serves one people, and refugee status passes from father to child. When it began work in 1950 it served about 750,000 Palestine refugees; some 5.9 million are eligible today. Shabbos Kestenbaum, the Jewish former Democrat who sued Harvard over antisemitism, put it in an August 2026 debate against ten anti-Zionists: there are more refugees nearly eighty years later than there were in 1948. In 2024 the UN’s own investigators found that nine UNRWA staff

may have taken part in October 7, and the United States cut off its funding.

Ashkenazi Jews were once the largest Jewish community on earth. Hitler killed six million of nine million European Jews. Had they lived, demographers estimate they would number roughly eighteen million today. The world's total Jewish population is sixteen million. The Holocaust did not only destroy six million lives. It erased every child and grandchild they did not live to have.

The Arab-Islamic conquest of the 7th century created the largest contiguous colonial empire the world had yet seen, from Spain to the borders of China. Egypt was Coptic Christian. Persia was Zoroastrian. Turkey was Greek Christian. North Africa was Berber. The Levant was a mix of Jews, Christians, and Samaritans. All were conquered and, over centuries, largely converted. The accusation of colonialism travels in one direction. The history goes the other way.

In Arabic, the word for slaves, abid, is what many Arabs call black people, because Arabs enslaved many sub-Saharan blacks and others until just recently: Mauritania made slavery a crime only in 2007, and in 2017 CNN filmed African migrants being auctioned

in Libya. Arabs and Islam colonized most of North Africa, Israel, and all across the Middle East to Central Asia, and Islam spread on to Southeast Asia through trade. In English, the word slave does not mean black. It comes from Slav: medieval traders sold so many white Slavic people, from Central and Eastern Europe, the Balkans and what is now Russia, that their name became the word.

Classical Islamic law divided the world in two: Dar al-Islam, the house of Islam, where its law rules, and Dar al-Harb, the house of war, where it has yet to rule. The sword carried it from the one to the other, and jihadists still carry it. In 2024, by the Global Terrorism Index, four jihadist groups caused 80 percent of the terrorism deaths pinned on any group: the Islamic State, al-Qaeda's JNIM in the Sahel, the Pakistani Taliban and Somalia's al-Shabaab. Muslims are most of the dead: 82 to 97 percent of terrorism's victims whose faith could be told, over five years, by the 2011 report of America's National Counterterrorism Center. James Carroll, a former Catholic priest who wants his church to repent its crusades against Islam too, said in 2002 that Islam has "serious foundational work to do": its preachers of jihad against Israel were reviving "some of the worst Christian manifestations of anti-Semitism." Like the plague in World War Z,

jihad is an existential, deadly zombie mind virus.

The Charge Sheet

Does the charge of genocide survive the arithmetic? Genocide is the intent to destroy a people. Here the people multiplied. Gaza's population grew from roughly 280,000 after the 1948 war to over 2 million by 2023, one of the fastest growth rates on the planet. A genocidal power with one of the world's most capable militaries, nuclear weapons, and total air superiority for 75 years produced a population that multiplied more than sevenfold. That is not what genocide looks like. It is what its opposite looks like.

Israel had the means for a genocide and did not use them. Total air superiority could have brought Gaza's buildings down on the people inside. Israel warned them to leave, moved them, paused the fighting so about 560,000 children could be vaccinated against polio, and sent soldiers door to door at the cost of their lives and limbs. The Fourth Geneva Convention forbids using civilians to make a place immune from attack (Article 28). Make a hospital untouchable because fighters hide under it, Kestenbaum said, and they get home base in a game of tag: strike, run inside, safe. Every war room moves under a hospital. In May 2025 Israel killed Hamas's Gaza chief, Mohammed Sinwar, brother of Yahya

Sinwar, who planned October 7, in a tunnel beneath the European Hospital in Khan Younis.

A war crime, if one is proven, is a crime to be tried. Every war has them. A genocide needs the intent to destroy a people. An American drone strike in Kabul in 2021 killed ten civilians, seven of them children. An American gunship destroyed a Doctors Without Borders hospital in Kunduz in 2015, killing 42. One American strike in Mosul in 2017 killed 105 civilians. The Pentagon called them errors. When Israel errs, the same critics call it intent.

Intent is the charge's hinge, and its star exhibit is a verse. South Africa told the International Court of Justice that Benjamin Netanyahu, Israel's prime minister, revealed genocidal intent when he said, after October 7, "You must remember what Amalek has done to you." Many observant Jews recite that verse, Deuteronomy 25:17, every morning among the six remembrances. It commands memory of an enemy who "smote the hindmost of thee, even all that were feeble behind thee" (25:18): an army that fell on the weak and the stragglers, as Hamas fell on the kibbutzim and the festival. The intent on the record runs the other way. On October 24, 2023, Ghazi Hamad of Hamas's political bureau told Lebanese television: "We must

teach Israel a lesson, and we will do it twice and three times. The al-Aqsa Deluge is just the first time.” Al-Aqsa Deluge is Hamas’s own term for October 7.

Hamas did not hide its intent; it published it. The 1988 Hamas charter quotes the hadith of the Gharqad tree: the end will not come until the Muslims kill the Jews, until the rocks and trees cry out, “O Muslim, there is a Jew behind me, come and kill him.” The 2017 revision was cosmetic, the word “Jew” traded for “Zionist,” the aim untouched.

On October 7, 2023, they carried it out: about 1,200 people killed in a single day, some 800 of them civilians, the worst slaughter of Jews since the Holocaust. In one recording a killer phones his parents from a murdered woman’s own phone to brag that he killed Jews with his bare hands, and they tell him to praise God.

Support for the massacre is not a fringe. Polls taken across Palestinian society after the attack found roughly three in four supporting it, support in the West Bank above eighty percent, a clear majority still calling it correct a year into the war that followed. Crowds handed out sweets.

The hatred is taught from the cradle: schoolbooks and summer camps, paid for by Western donors, glorify the martyr and erase

Israel from the map, and small children are filmed reciting that they will kill the Jews. A movement that raises its kindergartners for death and sends its teenagers to die behind the shields it built calls the army that texts civilians before it strikes the genocidal one. Only one side here wrote extermination into its founding document. It was not the Jews. The word genocide describes the charter of the accuser, and is fired at the accused.

The figure that 83 percent of the dead were civilians, from a 2025 investigation by The Guardian, +972 Magazine and Local Call, set an Israeli intelligence list of about 8,900 fighters individually confirmed dead against a health ministry total of about 53,000. A list of fighters identified one by one is a floor: a soldier who kills a man firing a rocket at him rarely learns who he was, and the army’s own estimate at the time was more than 20,000 fighters killed. Israel said throughout that the war would end when Hamas freed the hostages and laid down its arms. In October 2025 the last living hostages came home and a ceasefire took hold. A genocide does not end in a hostage exchange.

Kestenbaum’s questions finish the case. If Israel meant to destroy the Palestinians, why did it wait for the worst day for Jews since the Holocaust to begin? Why do two million Arab citizens of Israel vote and sit in its parliament, when the Nazis began with

Germany’s own Jews? Why did Israel, in 2005, pull about 8,500 of its own Jews out of Gaza, even moving 48 graves? Gaza had Jews long before it had Hamas: Israel Najara, a rabbi there four centuries ago, wrote Yah Ribon, still sung at Sabbath tables. Even the extremists the critics quote testify for the defense. Itamar Ben-Gvir, the far-right minister, was kept out of the war cabinet and spent the war complaining of what the government would not let him do. Had a genocide been under way, he would have had nothing to complain about.

October 7 was the worst terrorist attack perhaps ever recorded on the cameras of the terrorists themselves: butchery, rape, burning, the killing of babies, and the beheading of men, filmed and broadcast as propaganda. The response is called genocide. Apply the standard elsewhere. The United States firebombed Tokyo and dropped nuclear weapons on Hiroshima and Nagasaki. The standard answer is that this was not genocide because America rebuilt Japan into a prosperous democracy afterward. Yet the same people who call Israel’s response to October 7 a genocide also oppose the plan to rebuild Gaza. The contradiction reveals the game. If rebuilding proves it was not genocide, and you oppose the rebuilding, you do not want the exoneration. You want the accusation.

Under Palestinian Authority law, selling land to a Jew is punishable by death. Israel has Arab members of the Knesset, an Arab Supreme Court justice, Arab doctors, officers, and diplomats. Israel holds a Pride parade in Tel Aviv; Hamas executed one of its own commanders over accusations of gay sex. Which side practices apartheid?

In 2005 Israel withdrew from Gaza entirely, dismantled its settlements, and left behind commercial greenhouses. American Jewish donors, organized by envoy James Wolfensohn, purchased the greenhouse infrastructure for $14 million, hoping it would seed an economy. Within weeks the greenhouses were stripped and looted. Billions in international aid followed. The World Bank, UNRWA, the EU, Qatar, the UAE and others poured money into the territory. Infrastructure that could have been built was not. The funds were diverted, tunneled underground, or simply taken. Hamas built a network of tunnels under civilian areas while the civilian areas went without.

Singapore was smaller, poorer, and had no oil. What it had was property rights, the rule of law, education, and open trade. It went from Third World to First in one generation. Gaza had coastline, international goodwill, and billions in aid. What it lacked was the institutional structure that turns capital into prosperity. The

difference is not geography. It is governance.

Geography sets the limits, and people decide what to do within them. Jared Diamond, in Guns, Germs and Steel, stressed Africa's north-south shape; Thomas Sowell, the economist, stressed isolation. People advance by borrowing: Europeans crossed the Atlantic with Chinese rudders and counted with Indian numbers. Tropical Africa had less to borrow. The Sahara stood between it and the Mediterranean, its rivers fall a thousand feet through waterfalls on the way to the sea. The tsetse fly killed draft animals, and malaria killed people.

Isolation holds back any people. Russia had resources in abundance; what it lacked, Sowell wrote, "was not capital but the ability to use capital." The Soviet Union sat on some of the richest farmland on Earth and imported grain.

The rebuild question answers itself once you state it plainly. How do you reconstruct a territory still governed by the organizations that destroyed it? Hamas and Fatah kill Palestinians for opposing them. Dissidents are dragged through streets, thrown from buildings, shot in public. The leadership is a long line of men who trade in blood money and promise their foot soldiers a supernatural afterlife for the murder of civilians. Pour concrete

and they tunnel under it. Send generators and they power weapons manufacturing. Open a border crossing and they smuggle rockets through it. Every functional state was built on the same prerequisite: remove the people whose power depends on perpetual failure.

The exit exists and has been walked. The Abraham Accords proved that the moment a leader chooses prosperity over death, the conflict ends overnight: the UAE, Bahrain, Morocco, and Sudan made peace and lost nothing. The barrier is not the land. It was a theology that needs the Jew to fail. Pull that engine out and the war loses its motive. That is what this book does.

Christians in Israel grew from roughly 34,000 in 1949 to approximately 188,000 by 2024. In Bethlehem under the PA, the Christian share fell from around 85 percent to roughly 10 percent. In Iraq, from over 1.5 million before 2003 to fewer than 200,000. In Syria, from about 10 percent of the population to a fraction of that. In Gaza, the Christian population has been reduced to the hundreds. Christians are growing in one country in the Middle East, Israel, unsurprisingly the one anti-Zionists accuse of oppression.

Egypt built a wall. Jordan expelled Palestinians in Black September, 1970: in eleven days its army killed about 3,400 Palestinians by one count, three times as many as Israel’s army killed in the six years of the first intifada. Kuwait expelled approximately 400,000 Palestinians after the Gulf War because the PLO backed Saddam Hussein. Lebanon confines Palestinians to camps and bars them from dozens of professions. In Syria’s civil war, over 4,500 Palestinians died. Assad’s bombs, snipers, sieges and torture killed at least 3,196 of them by 2020, 491 under torture. No Arab neighbor takes them, and the world blames Israel for not solving the problem the neighbors enforce.

Palestinians kill Palestinians too. In that same first intifada, their own factions executed 771 to 942 of them as suspected collaborators, nearly as many as the 1,087 Israel’s army killed.

The Palestinian Authority pays monthly salaries to prisoners convicted of attacking Israelis, scaled to the severity of the attack and the length of the sentence. Kill more, earn more. The payments are budgeted, published, and defended. This is not an accusation. It is the PA’s own published budget.

The Institutions

The International Criminal Court’s chief prosecutor was suspended over allegations of misconduct. The court issued its first warrant against a Hamas commander only on November 21, 2024, more than a year after October 7, and only alongside warrants for Israeli leaders. It has never indicted Hezbollah or Iran. For years it indicted one side of one conflict in a region where the other sides commit the acts the court was built to address. A court that chooses its defendants before it weighs the evidence is a kangaroo court. The International Court of Justice has not found a genocide either. In January 2024 it ruled that Palestinians had a plausible right to be protected from genocide, and its president at the time, Joan Donoghue, said afterward that the court “didn’t decide that the claim of genocide was plausible.” Its own test, set in the Croatia case in 2015, demands that genocidal intent be the only reasonable conclusion from a pattern of conduct. Evacuation warnings, polio vaccinations and a ceasefire once the hostages came home leave other conclusions open.

Mutual assured destruction assumes both sides want to live. A regime whose theology promises the return of the hidden Imam through apocalyptic war does not share that assumption. Iran executes homosexuals, jails women for showing their hair,

massacres its own citizens in the streets. It arms Hezbollah, Hamas, the Houthis, and militias across Iraq. A nuclear Iran is not a second Soviet Union. It is a state whose end-times theology welcomes the fire.

The investment arithmetic settles the ally or liability question. The United States provides Israel roughly $3.8 billion annually in military aid. At least three quarters of it is spent on American weapons, and from 2028 all of it. All American aid to Israel since 1948, economic and military, comes to a little over $300 billion in today’s dollars. America keeps some 80,000 troops in Europe, and by a 2025 estimate Europe would have to spend about 250 billion euros more a year to defend itself without them: close to all of Israel’s aid since 1948, every year. Israel exports over $25 billion per year to the United States. The BIRD Foundation, established in 1977, has funded over 1,200 joint American and Israeli projects, generated tens of billions in combined GDP, and now self-funds entirely from returns on earlier investments.

The military return is harder to price but easy to list. The Trophy active protection system saves American vehicle crews. After tests in 2022 the Marine Corps chose Iron Dome’s launcher and interceptor for its own air defense. The Israeli emergency bandage is standard in every American combat medic’s kit.

Israel’s upgrades to the F-35 feed back into the American fleet. Iron Beam, a laser system that intercepts rockets and drones for a few dollars a shot, entered service at the end of 2025. The $3.8 billion is not aid. It is a defense procurement contract with a return that dwarfs the outlay. Many Zionists want it ended, calling it golden handcuffs that hold back Israel’s defense industry, which may compete with America’s, and keep Israel from making peace in the Middle East by winning its wars, rather than being divided and conquered by the United States. That may sound fine to some Americans, except that keeping such a dangerous balance let Iran enrich uranium to the edge of a bomb, to threaten or use on American cities.

The oldest institution in the dock is the church, and its case against the Jews began as self-defense. In 64 the emperor Nero blamed Christians for the fire of Rome and had them crucified or burned as torches, the Roman historian Tacitus wrote. So the Gospels lift the sentence off Pilate: in Luke he finds no fault in Jesus three times, and the crowds the priests feared too much to arrest Jesus in public suddenly cry, “Crucify him.” While Christians were hunted, the story only shielded them. Once the emperors were Christian, it became law against the Jews. Yet one of Elaine Pagels’s Harvard professors, a German Bible

scholar who had served in Hitler's army, told her there is nothing anti-Jewish in the New Testament.

The title made the danger plain. Augustus, the first emperor, styled himself divi filius, son of the deified Julius Caesar, and his coins carried it; Tiberius's silver denarius, the likeliest coin in "Render therefore unto Caesar" (Matthew 22:21), names him son of the divine Augustus. In Greek it is simply son of god. Emperors had their signs too: in Alexandria, Vespasian healed a blind man with his spittle (Tacitus, Histories 4.81), as Jesus does at Bethsaida (Mark 8:23). The emperor's cult flourished in Asia Minor and around the Aegean, from Pergamum's temple to Rome and Augustus in 29 BCE to Ephesus and Smyrna, the cities of Paul's letters and Revelation's seven churches, and Revelation calls Pergamum the place "where Satan's seat is" (2:13). Mark opens with "the Son of God" and, at the cross, puts the title in a Roman centurion's mouth: "Truly this man was the Son of God" (15:39). John's Thomas calls Jesus "My Lord and my God" (20:28), the title Domitian demanded for himself, dominus et deus. A crucified "King of the Jews" hailed as son of god was Caesar's rival, and confessing him was an act of rebellion: around 112 Pliny the Younger, Rome's governor in Bithynia, freed accused Christians who offered incense to the emperor's

image and cursed Christ.

James Carroll says reading the Gospels without the Roman war is like reading Anne Frank’s diary without the Nazi roundups in Amsterdam. The war ran, on and off, from 66 to 135: Josephus counts 1.1 million dead in the siege of Jerusalem alone, and Cassius Dio 580,000 killed in the last revolt. It set Jew against Jew, and the Gospels record one side of the quarrel: where John writes “the Jews,” Carroll says, read “those Jews who disagree with us Jews about Jesus.” Christians forgot the war, and some forgot who fought it: a Boston College professor, Carroll recalls, told a student that the Romans killed Jesus, and the student concluded, “Well, then they were Jews.”

Carroll followed the church’s case against the Jews through sixteen centuries in Constantine’s Sword (2001), titled after the cross the first Christian emperor carried into battle. Before him the catacombs show the fish, the shepherd and the loaves, and hardly a cross. The book opens at Auschwitz, where a great cross from a 1979 papal Mass was planted beside the camp: a sign of redemption to Catholics and, to Jews, one more Christian claim laid over Jewish death. After the Council of Nicaea in 325, Constantine cut Easter loose from Passover: “Let us then have nothing in common with the detestable Jewish crowd.”

By the end of that century heretics and pagans faced conversion or death, and Ambrose of Milan, the most powerful bishop of his day, wanted the same for Jews: in 388 he shamed the emperor Theodosius out of making Christians rebuild a synagogue they had burned at Callinicum. Augustine, whom Ambrose had baptized, refused. He had Jews live on among Christians as witnesses, in Carroll's gloss: "Jews must be allowed to survive, but never to thrive." Their misery was to prove the church right, so Jewish thriving reads as a threat. About 429 Rome let the Jewish patriarchate lapse, the last office of Jewish self-rule until 1948. In 1096 crusaders bound for Jerusalem first massacred the thriving Jews of Speyer, Worms and Mainz; in Mainz parents killed their own children rather than see them baptized, and synagogues still say the laments for them. In 1215 the Fourth Lateran Council ordered Jews into distinctive dress, and badges followed.

Augustine deserves the rest of the record too. From Psalm 59, "Slay them not," he argued that Jews must not be killed, and for centuries that doctrine gave Jews a protected, if degraded, place in Latin Christendom. In his Confessions he pictured God holding all of time at once, every past and future present together, fifteen centuries before relativity drew the block universe.

In On Free Choice of the Will he argued that seven and three make ten for everyone who reasons, now and always, a truth no mind made and none can change. In the City of God he wrote that God made the world in six days because six is a perfect number (equal to the sum of its divisors 1, 2, and 3), and that six would stay perfect even if the six days had never happened. He took the eternal truth of number as a road to God. Matheism takes it as God.

In 1391 mobs across Spain drove tens of thousands of Jews to the font, and the church found it could not trust a forced conversion. Spain's blood-purity statutes, from 1449, made Jewishness a matter of blood that baptism could not wash out; the Inquisition, from 1478, hunted the converts' secret Judaism; and the Jesuits kept a bar on Jewish descent, five generations back, until 1946: contempt for a religion became contempt for a race. The secret Jew became the enemy within, Carroll argues, a parasite on the body of Christendom, the picture the Nazis would paint of the German folk. In 1492 Spain expelled its Jews. Martin Luther told Christians in 1543 to set the synagogues on fire; when they burned on Kristallnacht in 1938, on his birthday, a Lutheran bishop, Martin Sasse, reprinted Luther's words in celebration. Much of the church's defense of Jews in the

Holocaust, Carroll notes, was a defense of the baptized; to Hitler, baptism changed nothing.

The turn came late. Angelo Roncalli, who as the Vatican's envoy in Istanbul during the war helped Jews escape, became Pope John XXIII and called the Second Vatican Council. The Vatican recognized Israel only in 1993. In 2000 John Paul II prayed at the Western Wall and left a note asking God's forgiveness for "those who in the course of history have caused these children of yours to suffer," which Carroll reads as the undoing of Augustine's two proofs, the scattering of the Jews and the ruin of their Temple. Yet in 2022 Carroll said he had naively thought, twenty years before, that the corner had been turned.

The truth stares them in the face of their own books, yet in supernatural lies, they lie to themselves and the world. In the fraudulent Gospel of John, written over sixty years after the events, Yeshua, a metaphor for salvation, was killed by Rome: like Neo defeats Agent Smith, salvation conquered Rome's demonic legions from within. Yet the dragon still lies on the one ring of power in the Vatican. Good Catholics feed it while praying it stays asleep. But today the Pope at times is a good leader of men, a shepherd for a flock of sheep, and in Nostra Aetate, at the Second Vatican Council, the church is making amends.

Amends for its ancient original sin, antisemitism: inverting and projecting a flipped reality onto the people who gave it its God, until it led to the Holocaust. Supersessionism comes from the Latin for sitting upon: the church sits upon the synagogue. Once the church had replaced Israel, Carroll says, Israel had no religious reason left to exist, and down the centuries that became no physical reason to exist, epitomized at Auschwitz. The Nazis did something new, Carroll told an audience at New York's 92nd Street Y in 2002, but they could not have done it without the ground the church prepared, and Pope Pius XII's silence during the Holocaust "is not the crime, it's the evidence." In 1965 Nostra Aetate ruled that Christ's passion "cannot be charged against all the Jews, without distinction, then alive, nor against the Jews of today," and that "God holds the Jews most dear for the sake of their Fathers." Carroll calls it the most important change in Christian theology ever. Even so, it keeps the Gospels' charge that "the Jewish authorities and those who followed their lead pressed for the death of Christ," and still calls the church "the new people of God." In 2015 the Vatican's commission for relations with the Jews wrote that the church "neither conducts nor supports any specific institutional mission work directed towards Jews."

Yet there’s also a time for the real truth to be revealed: that math is God and all is one, and that what a single man can correct, a single man can lead into devastation when he engages in politics from the seat of the one ring of power, which is wrapped around a supernatural lie. The salvation of Yeshua is in his monist teaching, in the Gospel of Thomas, that Matheism completes.

The oldest European export resurfaces in America. A generation of online nationalists, Nick Fuentes first among them, recycles the medieval Christian complaint: Jews hold too much power, and the power is not in America’s interest. The charge deserves a direct answer. What are the powerful Jews in America guilty of? Building nukes for America before her enemies do? Helping to build America into the world leader in artificial intelligence, finance, medicine, technology, mathematics, science, and business. Creating the largest and most successful companies on the planet. That is the indictment.

Why? In part because Fuentes pushes supersessionist replacement theology. How is this known? Because he’s repeatedly said it’s very “ominous” if a powerful ally like Israel holds down the Middle East so that the US can leave and focus on China and other US problems. Why is this ominous? Because replacement theology like that of Augustine’s failed prediction

that the Jews would be kept as a witness people, but kept down in shame, and powerless, for rejecting what the bible says: that God is not a man. Fuentes says it outright too. On October 16, 2026, he told his viewers, “We are blessed that the Jews passed the birthright to us,” and that it went to Antioch, Rome and Alexandria: “We are the custodians of the true faith. It’s our birthright now.” Vatican first, not America first: the chair of Peter over the Constitution.

Fuentes and his followers battle within whether to lie, LARP (play-act) or really believe in Christian nationalism, whether they love Jews, hate Jews, or were the real kings of Israel and the spiritual Jews. They pray to a Jew and drink his blood, which they invert and project onto Jews, as always. How about the truth, the one truth? Math is God and All.

A Hindu conservative runs for governor on identical policies to any Christian in the party. Some refuse to vote for him because his name is Vivek, his skin is brown, and he prays to the wrong god, despite his being a monotheist. They would sooner elect a pro-abortion National Socialist Neo-Nazi Democrat than a conservative who checks every box except race and religion. That is not a political disagreement. That is the tribe choosing the marker over the truth. Call it what it is: identity politics wearing a

cross.

Joel Webbon, a Christian nationalist pastor, says the quiet part: this country is not for Hindus, not for Muslims, and not for Jews, it belongs to Christians, and Jews cannot hold public office. The founders already answered in Article 6: no religious test shall ever be required.

Fuentes says critics psychoanalyze him instead of answering his facts and arguments. Take the arguments. He says Trump spent his political capital on the Iran war instead of mass deportation, Greenland and Canada. Trump got a Greenland deal, but to whatever degree he messed it up by going in too strong, it had nothing to do with Israel. Canada doesn’t want to be a state, the right doesn’t want their liberals voting, tax revenue washes out by benefit costs, and they already sell us their resources.

Israel does more of America’s bidding than the allies we pay to protect. Spain closed its bases and its airspace to the Iran war, and Italy refused the US its base at Sigonella. In March 2026 Britain, France, Germany, Japan and Australia all declined to send warships to the Strait of Hormuz. While leftists, socialists and Islamists who hate the West and their own nations tear at Europe with violent protests, and too many of its leaders

surrender to them, a tragedy for a great civilization and its people, Israel is America’s only fighting ally. The USA and Zion are ally heirs of a shared origin and Judaic Western civilization. Had Israel been next to North Korea or Pakistan, neither would have the bomb.

Deportation is a separate fight, and the Iran war took no money from it: in 2025 Congress gave border and immigration enforcement more than $170 billion over four years. On deportation Nick has a point many Americans share: some 14 million people lived here illegally in 2023, the law is broken, and removal should start with them. Nick answers that it won’t be enough, or that Trump isn’t doing it.

If Nick cares so much, he should stop the Democrats from winning and letting in tens of millions more; instead he wants things to get worse first, to hasten the fall of the republic and crown an American Caesar.

So in the end, is it just being a contrarian commentariat for higher views to keep momentum and superchat money? That’s what it seems to boil down to, realistically. He sells grievance that ironically destroys the American ethos that makes America glorious.

On immigration, the accusation of a monolithic Jewish position collapses on contact. Many patriotic American Jews and Zionists agree that illegal aliens should be removed, to keep a nation of laws, because citizens want higher-wage jobs, not competition from impoverished people from high-crime places and incompatible cultures. Mark Levin, the conservative radio host, was always firmly against mass migration changing demographics, and he moved Fuentes toward restriction, as Fuentes admitted to the talk show host Tucker Carlson. Stephen Miller, the architect of Trump's deportations, is Jewish. So is Laura Loomer, the right-wing activist, and a growing crop of Jewish commentators online are far harder on mass migration than the old guard. Kestenbaum argued in his August 2026 debate that a nation of laws cannot exempt the people who broke them; had he overstayed his student visa in Israel, Israel would have deported him. Ben Shapiro held a softer line, and even he has hardened: in July 2026 his show called the migrant wave into Spain a "Muslim invasion."

Ben Shapiro is the best-known Jewish voice on the American right, and the right under 40 does not trust him. His love of America reads as love of an America allied with Israel.

Shapiro also went along with official science the young right considers corrupt. On climate, he argued that even four degrees of warming would be no emergency, only a change to adapt to. On COVID, he got vaccinated twice and urged others to, though he fought the vaccine mandates from the start and called lockdown “not an alternative.” In 2022 he said: “We were lied to by everyone.” By then much of the young right had stopped listening. Tucker still sells whatever people buy, which is a lot of nonsense.

At the University of Iowa on October 8, 2026, on a tour of Turning Point USA, the conservative student group, a student in a “Jesus is King” shirt asked Ben Shapiro what it would take for him to become a Christian. Shapiro said Jews don’t believe you have to be Jewish to get into heaven: “If you’re not Jewish, all you have to do is fulfill seven basic rules. They’re called the Noahide laws.” The clip that spread stopped before his next words: “I think that you’re doing a great job by believing in Jesus. ... I think that you should continue to go to church.”

Critics, among them the Catholic outlet Integrity Magazine on October 12, answered that under Maimonides, the medieval Jewish philosopher, a gentile who breaks one of those laws is beheaded, and that worship of Jesus can count as idolatry.

Tucker sold that one too: Shapiro, he said, was “proposing a legal code in which my religion would be illegal.” Shapiro called the charge “psychotic” on October 14 and answered that “Jewish law requires no one except Jews to abide by Jewish law.” Christians, “with very few exceptions,” keep the seven laws “just by dint of the fact that they practice their religion,” he said, and “pretty much all Jews accept that Christians are not idolaters.” No record shows a gentile put to death under those laws. Better to tell Christians to keep the Ten Commandments. They know them from their own Bible, no critic can call them Talmud, and seven laws they have never heard of can sound condescending. The Ten hold most of the seven and add three: honor your father and mother, do not covet, and keep the Sabbath, which need not mean shutting off your phone, only a day to reflect on the one truth of Matheism and be grateful for the glory of its creation. The Ten Commandments are popular. Start there.

Amanda Milius makes the case from inside. She is Jewish, a Zionist and an American nationalist, and at the State Department she helped open the American embassy in Jerusalem. At the National Conservatism conference in Jerusalem, on October 7, 2026, she warned that the right under 40 is being lost. Calling every critic an antisemite empties the word, the way calling

everyone a racist emptied that one, and makes Jewish groups the young right's Black Lives Matter: "We are now at risk of becoming BLM to the younger American right." She owns a T-shirt that says: "I'm not anti-Semitic. I just don't like Ben Shapiro."

The next day, on the Israeli podcast Shomer HaSaf, the Gatekeeper, she called it the fastest political shift she had ever seen: in three years the right under 40 went from backing Israel to blaming it. In hard times people blame whoever succeeds, and they are as angry at American Jews as at Israel. The young right lived through a decade that taught it to stop believing accusations: the January 6 prosecutions, COVID censorship, debanking, the racism charges of 2020. So she would argue instead: documentaries that lay out the facts, debaters who stay calm, charisma to match the other side's, and no more lists of antisemites. She would even have AIPAC, which American citizens fund and so need not register as a foreign agent, register anyway to take the obsession off the table. And she suspects the speed of it all is not organic.

The young right's turn against Israel is bad for America, and it is no accident. We can't pierce the Iron Curtain of Russian propaganda or China's propaganda machine: China blocks

Facebook, YouTube and X, and Russia blocked Facebook and Instagram in 2022. They can invade ours. The attack on Israel is a symptom. Beyond the symptom, it attacks a powerful alliance that makes America strong, and the Pax Americana it helps hold. Russian, Chinese and Qatari propaganda pair up against it for that reason: to weaken America and push the world into a dangerous multipolar order. So do the opposite of what they want.

Tucker Carlson sells the division. In Moscow in December 2024 he told the world that “we are closer to nuclear war than any time in history”; in June 2025 he foresaw “the end of the American empire.” Russian state television runs his monologues, Iran’s state news agency ran his case against striking Iran, and he bought a home in Qatar.

Jonathan Keeperman, the publisher known online as Lomez, brought the numbers to the same conference. Pew found that 60 percent of Americans viewed Israel unfavorably in March 2026, and 57 percent of Republicans under 50. The young right’s first concern is mass immigration. When liberal Jews back it and the Anti-Defamation League demonizes populists, Israel pays the price. The memory of the Holocaust no longer moves them. Strength, competence and confident optimism do. They would

back an Israel that secures its own peace without drawing in American force.

About seven and a half million Jews live in America. Pew found that 71 percent identify with or lean toward the Democrats, and more than eight in ten say abortion should be legal in all or most cases. NatCon's case for American national sovereignty is the one many, if not most, American Jews need to see. I am Israeli, so my position may differ from most American Jews.

Matthew Peterson, president of the conservative group New Founding, asked the question American Jews have to answer. If Israel will not let itself be overrun by foreigners trained to call Jews oppressors, how can Jews back the mass migration of such people into Western countries? The answer is that those are different Jews. Jews are not a monolith, and the biggest group pushing immigration is Christian, the Catholic Church first, not Jewish. Peterson told Israel's right that the leader who says "We don't need your aid anymore. We're a sovereign nation like you" will be hailed by the young right as an honest leader. Opposing endless war is not hatred of Jews, he said, and the Anti-Defamation League lost its power over the right by attacking Trump, Elon Musk and Turning Point USA. But the endless wars come from Iran, and from never finishing them. Israel did not

push America into Afghanistan for twenty years or keep it in Iraq; its officials told Bush's team, as Colin Powell's chief of staff later recalled, "Iraq is not the enemy - Iran is the enemy." America's interest is to dominate the region, and the job ends when the Islamic Republic falls, freeing a people four in five of whom reject it: a regime whose morality police killed Mahsa Amini for showing her hair, and which in January 2026 killed thousands of protesters, up to 30,000 by the count of its own health officials reported by Time, most of them in two days, behind a near-total internet blackout.

Is JD Vance an antisemite? Maybe not, but he bends with the wind, and his critics bring evidence: he shape-shifts. Nick Fuentes calls him the Matrix candidate, ordered onto the ticket by Elon Musk, Peter Thiel and Tucker Carlson, and notes that even his name has shifted: born James Donald Bowman, then Hamel, then Vance. In 2016 he called Trump "cultural heroin" and privately wondered if he was "America's Hitler," then became his running mate. As vice president he declines to draw a line against Tucker Carlson and the antisemites gaining ground on the right. When Nick called him a "fat, gay race traitor" and slurred his wife, Usha, the daughter of Indian immigrants, Vance took about a month to answer. In short, he is a politician. Nick rails against

gays and Big Tech, yet the patrons he credits with Vance's rise are Peter Thiel, openly gay and a co-founder of Palantir, and Elon Musk. Marco Rubio, the Secretary of State, holds his line: he ran against Trump in 2016 and still holds the positions he always held, patriotic, conservative, time-tested American values, and he sees strong fighting allies like Israel as a powerful benefit to America and the Western civilization they share.

Milius and Keeperman are right about the tactics. Crying antisemitism at every critic fails the way crying racism failed. Keeperman's cure is the one this book gives: an Israel that holds its own fort, so America can mind its own house. The young right's suspicion still has a favorite exhibit: Jeffrey Epstein.

Epstein was a creature of the same Democrat establishment that opposes Israel from the American left. Many Jews in that orbit align with the party, not the people, and the party had by then made Israel a partisan question. The conspiracy theorists who cast Epstein as an Israeli asset ignore the simpler explanation: he moved in circles that saw Israel the way most Democrats did, as a problem to be managed, not an ally to be defended.

Carlson, after telling his audience he was attacked by demons, hosts guests who call Churchill the villain of the Second World

War, call algebra a Jewish ploy to trick gentile slaves, and blame every failure in creation on Jews and Israel while accusing everyone else of being obsessed with Israel.

Carlson says Japan never invaded America. As Book 1 showed, after Pearl Harbor it took Guam, Wake, the Philippines, and two Alaskan islands.

The European Christian complaint is not new. It is not American. It is the same inversion it has always been: the people who build are accused by the people who resent the building.

The “Jews control the banks” conspiracy collapses under five minutes of public filings. JP Morgan Chase, the largest bank in America: CEO Jamie Dimon is not Jewish. The top three shareholders, holding roughly nine percent of total shares, are not Jewish. The largest shareholder category is index funds, the model pioneered by John Bogle, who was not Jewish. Most American banks are private institutions with no public shareholders to control at all. The conspiracy requires a people comprising two percent of the population to secretly dominate an industry whose largest institutions file their ownership quarterly with the SEC. The filing is the debunking.

The overrepresentation is real. Roughly ten times their share of the American population in Nobel prizes, Supreme Court seats, Fortune 500 leadership, and billionaire lists. The question is not whether Jews are disproportionately present. They are. The question is whether the country is worse for it or better. The polio vaccine was free. Google, Facebook, and the transistor radio changed how the world communicates. The Constitution rests on Mosaic separation of powers and Levitical liberty. Hamilton, architect of the American financial system, studied Torah in Hebrew at a Jewish school on Nevis. Advancing the good, by their fruits.

The charge that Jews opened the borders forgets who guarded them. The left once fought illegal immigration to protect wages. Cesar Chavez's United Farm Workers union reported undocumented strikebreakers to the immigration service. In the mid-1970s his cousin Manuel Chavez ran a "wet line" of union men along the Arizona border to turn migrants back, and crossers who ignored the warnings were often beaten. "We're against illegals no matter where they work," Cesar Chavez said, "because if they are not breaking the strike they are taking our jobs." As senators, Barack Obama and Hillary Clinton voted for the Secure Fence Act of 2006, and Obama said America "cannot

allow people to pour into the United States undetected, undocumented, and unchecked.” In 2015 Bernie Sanders called open borders “a Koch brothers proposal.” Funny how the tables turned.

The immigration accusation fails twice. Catholic Charities was the largest refugee resettlement agency in the United States. The US Conference of Catholic Bishops advocated for comprehensive immigration reform for decades before ending its federal resettlement agreements in 2025. In August 2024, Pope Francis called opposition to migration a “grave sin.” Evangelical Lutheran, Episcopal, and Methodist organizations resettle refugees by the thousands every year. Christians do more institutional immigration work than any other religious group in America. The accusation lands on Jews anyway. The reason is not policy. Jewish Americans tend to be successful and concentrated in coastal cities where their politics match their neighbors’ politics exactly. A secular Jewish professional in Manhattan votes like every other secular professional in Manhattan. Singling out the Jewish ones for the politics of the zip code is not an immigration argument. It is the same old projection.

Paul wrote that in Christ there is neither Jew nor Greek. The same people opposing globalism are waiting for a single kingdom

under a single ruler with no borders anywhere. That is globalism with the serial numbers filed off. The objection is not to one world. It is to somebody else's. Wokeness and communism are Christian universalism with the cross filed off.

Beyond the theological reasons Islam and Christianity set against Israel, there is the secular coalition: communists, anti-Western ideologues, anti-colonialist inverters who call the indigenous return colonialism, radical individualists who oppose all group identity, the anti-tribal tribe. Add the self-described anti-racists who are racist against one multiracial people having their own single tiny country amidst a world full of ethnostates, aka nation-states. Germany, France, Spain, China, Japan, Korea, and dozens more. They have no problem with those. Only the Jewish one. Theology provides the mass, secular ideology provides the moral cover, and envy provides the fuel. Together they amplify into a loop where each faction confirms the others' accusation as justice.

The individualist argument that all tribalism is primitive sounds enlightened. It is also false. Identity and tribes are not social constructions layered over a blank universal nature. They are ancient forces written into biology across the animal kingdom: ant colonies, wolf packs, primate troops, bird flocks that mob

predators together. Humans form tribes because the math of cooperation rewards it, and four billion years of selection carved the reward into instinct. Pretending otherwise does not make you enlightened. It makes you wrong, and what is wrong eventually crashes into reality's wall. The left applies its anti-nationalism selectively: Palestinian nationalism is liberation, Israeli nationalism is colonialism. The selectivity reveals that the principle was never the point. The point was the accusation. On October 4, 2026, the Green Party of England and Wales voted 1,022 to 813 that Zionism "will be treated as any other form of racism," and called for a single Palestinian state. Anti-Zionists wish to destroy Israel. They either hate all nations, which their selectivity disproves, or they envy this one, a nation of creation and principles, striving to be the tribe of truth over tribalism.

The alternative is not complicated. Every nation controls its borders. Every nation selects its immigrants. Integration is mandatory. Trade flows freely between sovereign states. This is what the postwar liberal order actually was, before it forgot. The far right exists because the center abandoned the ground. The policy that prevents it is not more warnings about the far right. It is the policy the far right promises, delivered by people who are not. That is not a concession to extremism. It is the removal of its

oxygen. Nationalism for all nations, without shame, without supremacism, and without apology. The melting pot, the unmelted stew, the assimilated guest: three dishes, each real, each with costs. A restaurant serving only one lacks the diversity of nationalities. Meritocracy and open commerce between sovereign nations is the diversity that works: one selves empowering each other without requiring anyone to submit.

It’s time to end the story. The Jews are back in Israel, and they’re better off. America’s better off. Everyone’s better off without the supernatural. You don’t need to help Israel, and you don’t need to hate Israel. We don’t need your help, and we don’t need your destruction. Leave everyone alone. Let people exist in their nations.

In 2025, nearly two in three religion-based hate crimes reported to the FBI targeted Jews, about 2 percent of Americans. As Dr. Phil said at the UN on the third anniversary of October 7, “That’s not paranoia. That is pattern recognition.”

Thomas Sowell was asked for the one-word solution to antisemitism. He said: fail, “because as long as you succeed you’re going to be hated.” The success of the Jews undermines the replacement theologies of over four billion people, and what

people consumed with that envy call idol worship of a tribe is projection from people who idol-worship their own creed.

The same reasons Jews survive and thrive despite millennia of terrorism and pogroms are the same reasons the tiny minority is the repeated scapegoat target of hate crimes and double standards: supersessionist supremacist theology, ideology, and envy. Cain killing Abel. The engine that builds draws the fire, and the fire proves the engine works.